Purpose

The goal is to mimic the related works section of a paper. This means you should give an overview of the wider field and understand how your work fits into existing literature. Everything should discuss methodology more than experimental results or metrics (unless a benchmark / metric is what the project is).

Part 1: Overview of the Field (~7 mins)

Talk about works related to the wider field. This could cover between 10 and 30 works, but should not go into depth on any of them. You should talk about *general* trends and cite multiple methods that go into them, but you don't need to discuss the fine-grained details about any particular work. At the end, it should be clear that you understand alternatives to the methodological style of your project. This should also include pros and cons of these options.

An example of what this looks like in a paper is shown below, from a paper that was interpreting the latent spaces of models (The Latent Color Subspace: Emergent Order in High-Dimensional Chaos, Pach et al., ICML'26). (this is even shorter than what your verbal description will be, but can serve as some intermediate explanation).

Despite rapid advances in T2I models, their underlying mechanisms remain less explored. Prior work has begun to uncover key internal processes, including why they generalize (Niedoba et al., 2025), how they generate spatial relations (Wang et al., 2026), and how biases emerge (Shi et al., 2025). Complementary approaches leverage attention mechanisms within T2I models to analyze or control generation (Chefer et al., 2023; Hertz et al., 2023; Tang et al., 2023), as well as sparse autoencoders to identify interpretable and intervenable directions in model representations (Kim et al., 2025b; Daujotas, 2024; Shabalin et al., 2025; Shi et al., 2025). Furthermore, attention mechanisms in DiT models have proven effective for segmentation (Kim et al., 2025a; Helbling et al., 2025; Hu et al., 2025).

Controlled Generation
Control in T2I models

Interpreting Latent Representations in Diffusion Models
Intepretability of T2I models (or other VLMs)

Part 2: Closely Related Methods (~7 mins)

This section should focus on works addressing the same problem as yours, prioritizing those that are most directly comparable. It could likely cover 5-10 works. You will go into more detail than in the previous section, because you need to talk about how it differs (and this will be more fine-grained), but it is still relatively brief (we do not need to understand how to implement the paper). Again, it is good to discuss pros and cons.

An example of what this looks like in a paper is shown below, from a paper that was interpreting the latent spaces of models (The Latent Color Subspace: Emergent Order in High-Dimensional Chaos, Pach et al., ICML'26). (this is even shorter than what your verbal description will be, but can serve as some intermediate explanation).

Color control in FM models has been studied via color conditioning (Shum et al., 2025) and color–style disentanglement (Zhang et al., 2025). It can be enabled by learned color prompts (Butt et al., 2024), IP-Adapters (Laria et al., 2026), and inpainting or ControlNet-based approaches (Liu et al., 2025). These methods increase model complexity without improving interpretability, whereas ours leverages understanding to enable control. Others focus on color control in editing (Liang et al., 2025; Vavilala et al., 2025; Yang et al., 2025). Concurrent work analyzes color encoding in

Controlled Generation
Segmentation to image (or positional generation / position control)

Interpreting Latent Representations in Diffusion Models
Control in T2I models

Part 3: Most Closely Related Method(s) (~5-6 mins)

This section should be quite in-depth, on the most closely 1-2 pieces of literature (these are typically ‘key work’ on the presentation). It should focus on the aspects most related to what you will do, anything that is the same or will be used, as well as how your project will extend upon this.

An example of what this looks like in a paper is shown below, from a paper that was interpreting the latent spaces of models (SUB: Benchmarking CBM Generalization via Synthetic Attribute Substitutions, Bader et al., ICCV’25). (this is even shorter than what your verbal description will be, but can serve as some intermediate explanation).

enforcing explainability. FunnyBirds [24] consists of imaginary birds created from independent attributes, which are removed and replaced to evaluate model explanations. Similarly, Heidemann et al. [23] tested CBMs using a comparable dataset. Different from the previous works, the images in SUB are far more natural, bringing them much closer to real-world problems. Since our generated images resemble the types of birds found in the widely used CUB dataset [63], they can be leveraged to evaluate existing models trained on bird classes, eliminating the need for specialized training and creating a natural evaluation environment.

Controlled Generation
Semantic Image Synthesis with Spatially-Adaptive Normalization, Park et al, CVPR’19 OR
Stitch: Training-Free Position Control in Multimodal Diffusion Transformers, Bader et al, arXiv’25 OR another

Interpreting Latent Representations in Diffusion Models
The Latent Color Subspace: Emergent Order in High-Dimensional Chaos. Pach et. al, ICML’26